3. Elastin formation is impaired in copper deficiency.

4. Copper deficiency turns hair grey, which however, can be controlled by administration of copper.

5. Deficiency of copper is sometimes associated with decrease in taste sensitivity, which is restored by oral administration of copper.



Figure 9.14 Grey hair (Copper deficiency)

9.3.3. Iodine

The adult human body contains about 50 mg of organically bound iodine. Nearly half of this is present in muscles. Most of the body iodine is present in the thyroid gland, but all cells contain traces of iodine.

Functions

The thyroid gland is chiefly concerned with the uptake of iodine for the synthesis of the thyroid hormones, tetra Iodothyronine(Thyroxin T4) and tri Iodothyronine(T3) which influence a large number of metabolic functions. These iodine containing hormones regulate energy metabolism, synthesis of proteins and cholesterol and also in the conversion of carotene to vitamin A.

Unit 9.indd 243 21-05-2018 15:12:14